

Teaching Statement – Max Schroeder

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My approach to teaching is shaped both by my experience as an educator and by my own experience as a student. Throughout my education, I learned most effectively in environments where complex ideas were discussed collaboratively, where intuition was developed alongside formal methods, and where students were encouraged to actively engage with material rather than passively receive it. These principles continue to guide my teaching philosophy today.

At its core, my teaching aims to help students develop strong analytical and quantitative skills alongside a clear economic intuition. I aim to equip students not only with technical tools, but also with the ability to use these tools critically to analyse real economic problems. Across all levels of teaching, I emphasise clarity, structure, and relevance, ensuring that formal concepts are motivated by empirical evidence, real-world applications, and policy questions wherever possible.

A central element of my teaching practice is the encouragement of peer learning and active participation. I view learning as a collaborative process and consistently encourage students to see their peers as resources in their own educational journey. This approach benefits students on both sides of the interaction, reinforcing conceptual understanding while also helping them develop important interpersonal skills such as communication, teamwork, and constructive feedback. In seminars, tutorials, and computer labs, I prioritise discussion and guided problem-solving over one-directional instruction, allowing students to articulate their reasoning, learn from alternative approaches, and develop confidence in their analytical abilities. This approach is particularly valuable in quantitative subjects, where students often arrive with very heterogeneous backgrounds in mathematics, statistics, and programming.

I have extensive teaching experience across a wide range of levels and roles, including Graduate Teaching Assistant, course coordinator, and lecturer, teaching undergraduate, Honours, and MSc students across several UK institutions. My core teaching expertise lies in technical and quantitative subjects, including mathematics for economists, statistics, econometrics, macroeconomics, MATLAB, and quantitative methods. I have taught these subjects repeatedly in settings that require careful scaffolding of material and sustained student support, particularly in compulsory courses taken by students with diverse academic backgrounds.

Alongside this technical focus, I have also taught and co-designed courses with a stronger historical, institutional, and pluralist orientation, most notably *Financial Institutions and Markets in Developing Countries*. This course incorporated substantial heterodox perspectives and encouraged students to engage critically with alternative economic frameworks. I view this experience as complementary to my quantitative teaching: exposing students to a diversity of viewpoints strengthens their ability to evaluate models, assumptions, and empirical evidence critically.

As I transitioned from tutorial-based teaching into lectureship and course coordination roles, I increasingly took responsibility for the full design and delivery of courses. As course coordinator for a compulsory MSc-level course *Quantitative Methods in Finance*, with approximately 80 students, I designed the syllabus, developed lecture materials, computer labs, and seminars, and set and marked in-course assessments and examinations. I also provided additional academic support through office hours, online forums, and revision sessions. This role required careful coordination of content, assessment design, and delivery to ensure consistency and coherence across the course.

This course was taught in the immediate post-Covid period, which posed additional challenges for both students and instructors. Many students faced constraints on in-person attendance and varying levels of preparedness following disruptions to earlier stages of their education. To address this, I adopted a flipped classroom approach, replacing traditional lectures with short recorded videos that students could engage with asynchronously. In-person contact time was then used primarily for discussion, problem-solving, and practical exercises. I complemented this structure with regular low-stakes quizzes delivered through the Canvas platform, providing students with opportunities to check their understanding and receive feedback throughout the term. I also invited guest lecturers to demonstrate how quantitative methods are applied in research and professional contexts, helping students connect technical material to real-world applications.

Across my teaching, I pay close attention to student feedback and continuously reflect on how courses can be improved. In earlier teaching roles, feedback highlighted the value students placed on additional worked solutions and extended explanations of challenging material. In response, I developed supplementary written solutions and made them available outside of scheduled class time. I view this process of iteration and adaptation as central to effective teaching, particularly in technically demanding subjects.

I consistently receive strong student feedback, including in courses such as econometrics and quantitative methods that are often perceived as challenging. While I do not see positive evaluations as an end in themselves, I take them

as evidence that a structured, supportive, and conceptually focused approach can help students engage successfully with demanding material.

I also have experience of collaborative teaching design and delivery. In *Financial Institutions and Markets in Developing Countries*, I worked closely with a colleague to coordinate lecture content, assessments, and examinations, ensuring coherence across different teaching components. This experience strengthened my ability to contribute constructively to teaching teams and to programme-level curriculum development.

Looking ahead, I am well placed to contribute to teaching in quantitative methods, econometrics, statistics, macroeconomics, and public economics at both undergraduate and postgraduate levels. I am particularly interested in developing a course focused on model-based empirical analysis using simulation methods, which would place the data-generating process at the centre of empirical work. Such a course would help students develop a deeper understanding of how economic theories can be tested using data, while simultaneously strengthening their programming skills.

I am committed to the continuous development of my teaching practice and intend to work towards formal teaching accreditation through the Higher Education Academy. I am also attentive to the challenges and opportunities posed by the increasing use of artificial intelligence in higher education, and I am keen to explore how AI tools can be integrated responsibly into teaching and assessment to support student learning while maintaining academic integrity.